

The Dhāraṇī Called 'Cloud of Offerings'

Pūjāmegha nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 538 · Derge Kangyur

མཆད་པའ་སྒྲིལ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཐུགས་

Toh 538 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Pūjāmegha dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Mchod pa'i sprin zhes bya ba'i gzungs, meaning "The Dhāraṇī Called Cloud of Offerings." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a sacred mantra formula together with a brief account of its extraordinary merit, according to which the mere act of recollecting it is said to be equivalent to making vast offerings and prostrations to all the buddhas of the ten directions. The text opens with homage to the Three Jewels and to the tathāgata Vajrasārapramardanī, followed by the dhāraṇī itself in Sanskrit transliteration, before describing the immense spiritual benefits that arise from its recitation and remembrance.

The recollection of the marks is complete.

In the language of India: Pūjāmegha nāma dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "Cloud of Offerings."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namō bhagavate vajrasārapramardani tathāgatāya
arhate samyakṣambuddhāya. Tadyathā: oṃ vajre vajre, mahāvajre,
mahātejovajre, mahāvidyāvajre, mahābodhicittavajre,
mahābodhimaṇḍopasamkramaṇavajre, sarvakarmāvaraṇaviśodhanavajre
svāhā.

The ritual of this dhāraṇī mantra is as follows. The mere moment of recollecting it causes one to have made offerings to, and to have prostrated at the feet of, all the blessed buddhas dwelling in the ten directions in a number equal to the finest particles of sand grains of the Ganges River. One comes to have made offerings of flowers, incense, perfume, garlands of flowers, unguents, powder, parasols, victory banners, all manner of pennants, thrones, canopies, garments, fine food and drink, and the like, together with ornaments and all manner of adornments. One becomes free of all evil and comes to possess all roots of virtue. Upon seeing all buddhas and bodhisattvas, one is perfectly relieved and gladdened. All gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, great mahoragas, Vajrapāṇi and the other lords of secrets, the four great kings — all these follow in one's wake and truly accompany one,

Translator's Notes

- The passage closes mid-sentence, as the source text is itself cut off; the translation ends at the same point without completing the sentence.

The term rendered "fine food and drink" (bshos gtsang ba) literally means "clean porridge" or "pure food-offering"; it denotes a ritual food-offering, here translated idiomatically for a listening audience.

"Lords of secrets" (gsang ba'i bdag po) is a standard epithet-class for the guhyapati figures headed by Vajrapāṇi.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.